

Trump adds new peril for GOP ahead of midterms

Inflation was easing. Then he amped up war, tariffs.

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — As July began, things were finally looking up for President Trump and his fellow Republicans as the high cost of living slowly began to ease heading toward the midterm elections.

Gasoline had dropped below \$4 a gallon as a cease-fire took hold in the Iran war. With the help of a Supreme Court ruling that overturned a swath of Trump's tariffs, the global trade war had eased. And Congress had overwhelmingly approved a bipartisan bill to address the high cost of housing.

Then, in typical Trump fashion, he abruptly upended it all — and, in the process, added new peril for Republicans in November.

First, he resumed major US military attacks against Iran after it struck oil tankers in the Persian Gulf, sending gas prices surging above \$4 a gallon again and threatening to reignite still-high inflation. Then on Monday he imposed 50 percent tariffs on most Canadian imports, followed by new levies announced Thursday on dozens of countries to replace expiring ones — moves that could drive up costs for Americans and trigger retaliatory tariffs that add to upward price pressures.

TRUMP, Page A12

AVENUE OF BROKEN TRUST

On a tiny block, a microcosm of housing tensions

For residents, investments upset a hard-won balance

Second in a series.

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

Before the dynamite blasts, Culbert Street was quiet.

Here, on this small dead end in Mattapan, just off Blue Hill Avenue, is a slice of Boston's middle class. There are seven houses on the street, which abuts an expansive, heavily used park. All the houses are Black-owned and have been in their respective families for decades.

It's the type of street where everyone knows everyone. The kind of place, older residents say, where you want to raise a family. Where football games are played at the park, and there's neighborhood trick-or-treating. When Patricia Venter moved here decades ago, she liked that it seemed "nice and quiet."

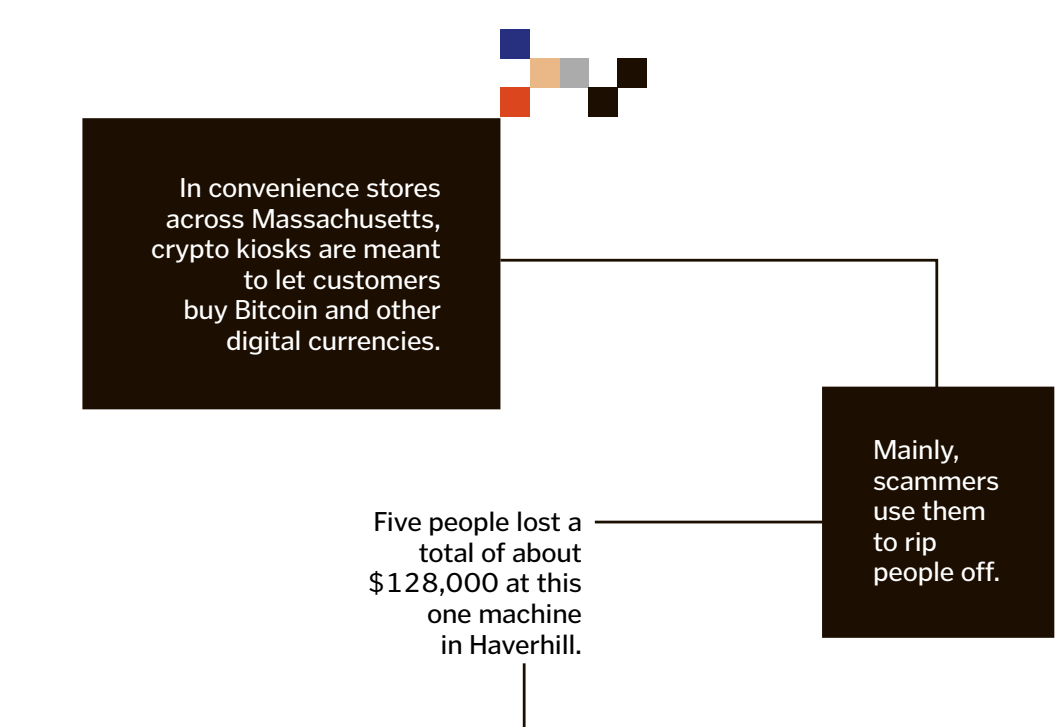
But last year, the explosions started. Months of sporadic dynamite blasts, followed by excavators clawing dirt and rock, disturbing the neighborhood and remaking the empty lot at the end of

MATTAPAN, Page A15



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

David Venter stood on his Culbert Street balcony, which overlooks the affordable housing project in Mattapan.



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

That crypto machine in Haverhill was soon back in business.

A scam machine, with few protections

By Scooty Nickerson
GLOBE STAFF

The men stood in the back of Sam's, a convenience store in Haverhill, with a question hanging between them: Who got to keep the \$21,790 in cash?

On the morning of June 7, 2023, they filed into the shop, just a few minutes' drive from the New Hampshire border. It was an unusual group: Three police officers, two officials from the county prosecutor, and a businessman from Las Vegas.

They walked past rows of candy and snacks to gather around an orange crypto kiosk, where customers can convert their cash into Bitcoin or other cryptocurrencies.

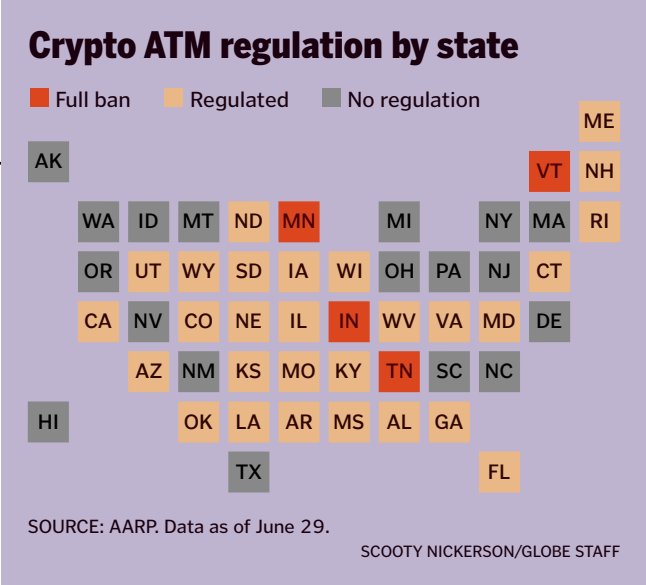
The crypto machine looked a lot like an ATM: it had a digital screen, a slot to put in money, and a lockbox inside to hold it. But there was one key difference: Cash only ever went in, never came out. For at least five customers, it was a digital black hole.

A woman had lost \$21,790 in the machine back in April, after online scammers persuaded her that buying cryptocurrency was the only way to protect her money from hackers. Once the scammers vanished, she called the police.

Stephen Beaulieu, a police detective in neighboring Merrimac where the woman lived, responded. He'd never seen a

CRYPTO, Page A8

Unlike 32 other states, Massachusetts doesn't regulate the kiosks. That leaves each one as a digital black hole.



SOURCE: AARP. Data as of June 29.

SCOOTY NICKERSON/GLOBE STAFF

Red flags in ICE's rush to hiring

Agent in Maine recruited despite multiple issues

This story was reported by Shannon Larson, Jeremiah Manion, Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, Emma Platoff, Sabrina Shankman, Lea Skene, and Nick Stoico of the Globe staff. It was written by Platoff and Skene.

AUGUSTA, Maine — Protective orders that required him to relinquish his guns. A severe head injury that he said impaired his cognitive function. A yearslong trail of abuse allegations from two ex-wives, documented in hundreds of pages of court records.

David Brouillette's past was full of red flags when he sought a job at US Immigration and Customs Enforcement last year. But the agency, which was undertaking a massive push to expand the ranks of US immigration agents, hired him anyway. It's unclear whether ICE didn't know or didn't care about the warning signs.

Now, Brouillette's troubled background has come to light after he was identified as the agent

ICE, Page A13

The race is on in Maine

With Graham Platner out, Democrats nominated Troy Jackson to take on Senator Susan Collins. **B1.**



There are thousands of places to camp in New England, but some are better than others. Check out our favorites. **N11.**

Faneuil Hall could use a little help these days. Here's how it could be fixed. **K1.**

Streak goes on

Sunday: Sunny, pleasant. High 71-76. Low 56-61.

Monday: More of the same. High 75-80. Low 62-67.

Complete report, A22.

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